

The Boston Globe

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The time had come for ‘best of best’ food hall

Inconsistent foot traffic, climbing costs, issues with location led to Time Out’s demise

By Janelle Nanos
GLOBE STAFF
and Hannah Goeke
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Time Out Market wanted its Boston location to be an upscale affair.

When the media empire’s scouts began visiting here in 2017 to sniff out possible vendors, they aimed to replicate Time Out’s Lisbon marketplace, which had become an international triumph. After decades publishing restaurant listings in its portfolio of magazines, the London-based Time Out Group’s first brick-and-mortar

manifestation was a one-of-a-kind hybrid of high and low cuisine, with Michelin-star chefs serving fast casual dishes on china with flatware. It quickly became Portugal’s biggest tourist attraction. Time Out Market soon expanded to New York, Miami, and eventually more than a dozen cities across the globe.

In Boston, Time Out took an approach not unlike Michelin Guide reviewers, anonymously visiting restaurants several times to ensure quality was up to its standards, before inviting them to join the huge outpost they were planning in the Fenway. So when Nina and Raffi Festekjian learned that the food at their South

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ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

Time Out Market is scheduled to close on Jan. 23.

Healey says she’ll cut red tape for patients

New regulations target insurers’ requirements for prior authorizations

By Jessica Bartlett
GLOBE STAFF

Massachusetts health insurers will face new restrictions around the much-maligned practice of prior authorizations, eliminating the red tape around how patients access some drugs and services, Governor Maura Healey said Wednesday.

Healey announced at the State House that the Division of Insurance will establish regulations to eliminate any insurer permissions required for many routine and essential services. The changes, along with some other reforms, take aim at a practice that’s long drawn the ire of many consumers upset over insurer denials.

Though insurers call prior authorizations an essential tool they use to control spending, Healey suggested the changes will lower health care costs by reducing the administrative burdens medical providers face.

“Health care is too difficult and too expensive for far too many people,” said Healey, who has made affordability a key issue on the campaign trail in her reelection bid in this November’s election. “So we are taking the most comprehensive action in the country to make it faster, cheaper, and easier to get the care you need.”

Healey also announced a new working group focused on health care affordability that will include leaders in business, health care, in-

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A MEMORABLE BREAKTHROUGH



CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

Brigadier General Enoch “Woody” Woodhouse II, a Roxbury native and one of the last surviving Tuskegee Airmen, received a blessing Wednesday from Father Jack Ahern as Woodhouse marked his 99th birthday in Quincy. **B1.**

An ex-commander in the Boston Police Department is suing Commissioner Michael A. Cox, alleging he was demoted after identifying possible corruption in paid detail programs. **B1.**

Iranian officials signaled that fast trials and executions are ahead for people detained in nationwide protests. **A3.**

The Trump administration is halting immigrant visa processing for people from 75 countries in the latest effort to restrict legal immigration. **A2.**

The MBTA has dropped a plan to redevelop the crumbling Alewife Station garage, citing market conditions. **D1.**

The Red Sox signed free agent lefthander Ranger Suárez to a five-year, \$130 million contract, days after Alex Bregman chose to sign elsewhere. **C1.**

Progress slow on Boston school buildings

Money issues keep construction and renovation on hold

By John Hilliard
and Christopher Huffaker
GLOBE STAFF

The challenge facing Boston’s public schools is stark: Years of declining enrollment have left the city with more school buildings than it needs.

Administrators argue they must consolidate children into fewer, larger schools to better serve them. Meanwhile, the district relies largely on aging buildings erected before World War II, many in poor condition and designed without cafeterias, gyms, auditoriums, or science labs.

That means as the district has closed schools, many of the students have moved from one crumbling building with limited offerings to an-

other.

So at the same time the city is closing schools, it must also build new schools and renovate other buildings to ensure students have access to a quality education in modern facilities. It all adds up to a massive task for Mayor Michelle Wu, who just promised to make the public education system the best urban district in the country.

Starting in 2022, shortly after she took office, Wu pledged to work toward the goal of overhauling the schools, with \$2 billion dedicated to improving BPS facilities, including \$605 million for 14 major school construction or renovation projects in fiscal years 2023 through 2027. Only three renovations have been completed so far, with no other projects under construction, and finishing the rest will require billions more dollars.

In a parallel process, the School Committee has approved a dozen clo-

sures and mergers since Wu took office. They have proven largely unpopular with many impacted families and educators, in part because Wu has made so little progress on the 14 major projects she announced in 2022.

“We have too many school buildings, and most of them are old,” said Will Austin, a former public school teacher, principal, and founder of Boston Schools Fund, a nonprofit working to improve BPS. “Those are just the facts, and so it is very difficult to navigate those two things at the same time.”

Martin J. Walsh, a former US labor secretary who served as Boston mayor from 2014 to 2021, said delays in school construction are not about a lack of expertise, but a lack of funds.

It can take about five years to work with the state to obtain school funding assistance, Walsh said. And

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As US stops making cents, a penny-ante problem for businesses

By Dana Gerber
GLOBE STAFF

As the one-cent coin hastens its long march toward obsolescence, Julio’s Liquors in Westborough has entered an era of penny-pinching.

A sign at the checkout counter — next to the leave-a-penny, take-a-penny dish — implores customers to sell their pennies to the store, instead, for their value in paper cash.

The notice went up, said store owner Ryan Maloney, after the US Treasury Department terminated the production of the penny last year, citing rising costs and disuse. This inevitably led to shortages at retailers, including Julio’s, which are now tasked with devising their own methods of negotiating cash transactions without the coins.

With little government guidance on how to lawfully undertake the transition, and loath to give up even a few cents by rounding transac-

tions down to the nearest nickel, Maloney is instead trying to kick the coin jar down the road.

“We’re sort of hoarding,” said Maloney, who has run Julio’s since 2000, “so that we don’t have to deal with this problem.”

It’s a problem playing out in cash registers across Massachusetts and the country as the realities of a penniless future begin to present themselves.

When Canada phased out its one-cent coin a little more than a decade ago, it offered retailers and consumers a clear path forward, suggesting that cash transactions be rounded up or down to the nearest nickel — \$1.61 and \$1.62 become \$1.60, while \$1.63 and \$1.64 become \$1.65 — with sales tax applied before rounding. In Massachusetts, retailers say they have been given little such direction from the federal or state government, bringing about a

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LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

Ryan Maloney, owner of Julio’s Liquors in Westborough, is asking his customers to sell him their pennies.



Wrap it up

Thursday: Mild early, cold late. High 47-52. Low 19-24.

Friday: Sun’s back, brisk. High 31-36. Low 27-32.

Sunrise: 7:11 Sunset: 4:37

Weather and Comics, D5-6.

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\$4.00



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